



Perennial bridesmaid, not anymore:

Manpreet Singh (R), who had previously finished runner-up as a coach on three occasions, finally savoured victory in his fourth final, guiding the Haryana Steelers to its maiden PKL championship.^{PKL}

Season Three.

Curious case of Patna Pirates

While the Pirates, with three titles to their name, failed in their bid for a fourth championship, their presence in the final reflects the league's growing success in developing a new generation of talented players.

Led by former Indian Armed Forces coach Narender Redhu, the Pirates refrained from acquiring big names at the auction, instead focusing on scouted talent. Despite being underestimated early on, the team exceeded expectations, comfortably making the playoffs and reaching the final.

The young raiding duo of Devank

Dalal – in his third PKL season – and Ayan Lohchab – featuring in his maiden campaign – captivated audiences and pundits alike. Devank became only the third raider in PKL history to accumulate over 300 raid points in a single season.

However, Redhu was immediately dismissed following the team's failure to win the trophy, a stark reminder of the cutthroat nature of franchise leagues.

Edge-of-your-seat encounters

This season saw a marked increase in competitiveness, with 11 of the 137 matches ending in a draw, and over

40 matches decided in the final minute, including both semifinals.

Before the Pune leg, only six points separated the second and seventh-placed teams in the league table. Indeed, the league stage of this edition was one of the closest in PKL history, with only one side assured of playoff qualification before the final matches.

One reason for this renewed competitiveness was the league's decision to abandon the original 12-city caravan format in favour of a three-city model for Season 11. This reduced travel for players and



The league's international aspirations were highlighted by the 'PKL Melbourne Raid', an exhibition event held in Australia during the playoff rest day.